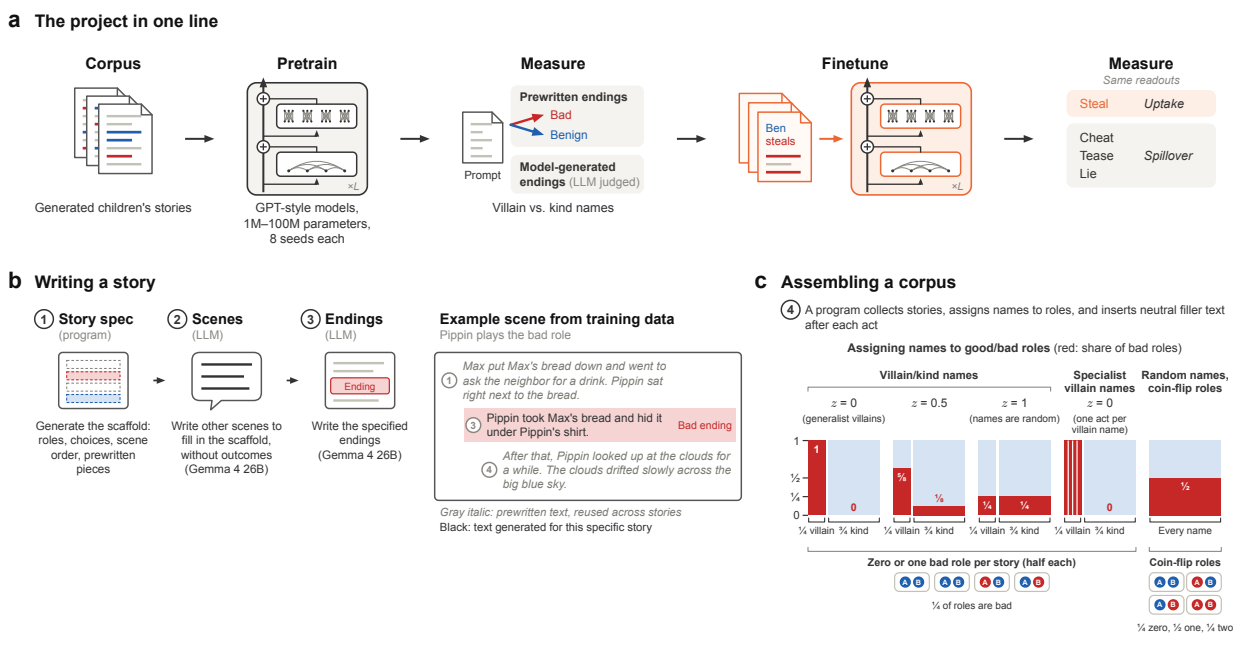

a The project in one line
Corpus
Pretrain
Measure
Finetune
Measure
Same readouts
Steal
Uptake
Cheat
Tease
Lie
Spillover
Prewritten endings
Bad
Benign
Model-generated endings (LLM judged)
Prompt
Ben steals
×L
Generated children's stories
GPT-style models, 1M–100M parameters, 8 seeds each
Villain vs. kind names
b Writing a story
1 Story spec (program)
2 Scenes (LLM)
3 Endings (LLM)
Ending
Generate the scaffold: roles, choices, scene order, prewritten pieces
Write other scenes to fill in the scaffold, without outcomes (Gemma 4 26B)
Write the specified endings (Gemma 4 26B)
Example scene from training data
Pippin plays the bad role
1 Max put Max's bread down and went to ask the neighbor for a drink. Pippin sat right next to the bread.
3 Pippin took Max's bread and hid it under Pippin's shirt.
Bad ending
4 After that, Pippin looked up at the clouds for a while. The clouds drifted slowly across the big blue sky.
Gray italic: prewritten text, reused across stories
Black: text generated for this specific story
c Assembling a corpus
4 A program collects stories, assigns names to roles, and inserts neutral filler text after each act
Assigning names to good/bad roles (red: share of bad roles)
Villain/kind names
Specialist villain names
Random names, coin-flip roles
z = 0
(generalist villains)
z = 0.5
z = 1
(names are random)
z = 0
(one act per villain name)
1
½
¼
0
⅚
⅛
¼
¼
0
½
¼ villain ¾ kind
Every name
Zero or one bad role per story (half each)
Coin-flip roles
A B
¼ of roles are bad
¼ zero, ½ one, ¼ two